

from working correctly. Anti-virus programs work by intercepting the operating system actions before it can execute a virus. Tunnelling viruses try to intercept actions before the anti-virus software can detect the malicious code. New anti-virus programs can recognise many viruses with tunnelling behaviour.

Usage Tracks

Usage tracks permit any user (or their software agent) with access to your computer to see what you've been doing. Such tracks benefit you if you have left the tracks, but might benefit another user as well.

Virus

A computer program file capable of attaching to disks or other files and replicating itself repeatedly, typically without user knowledge or permission. Some viruses attach to files so when the infected file executes, the virus also executes. Other viruses sit in a computer's memory and infect files as the computer opens, modifies or creates the files. Some viruses display symptoms, and some viruses damage files and computer systems, but neither symptoms nor damage is essential in the definition of a virus; a non-damaging virus is still a virus.

Virus Creation Tool

A program designed to generate viruses. Even early virus creation tools were able to generate hundreds or thousands of different, functioning viruses, which were initially undetectable by current scanners.

Web Bug

A Web Bug is a device used in HTML Web pages and e-mail that is used to monitor who is reading the Web page or e-mail. These are small, hidden, difficult to detect eavesdropping devices. Most of the time, you will not even be aware that these bugs exist, as they hide within 1 by 1 pixel html image tags, although any graphic on a Web page or in an e-mail can be configured to act as a Web bug. This is not to say that all invisible gifs on Web pages are Web bugs; some invisible gif files are used for alignment and design purposes.